Living for the Hope of it All!

By: Ahliyah Luna

My joyful puppet in a world that tugs
and pulls. Barely standing, yet you
hop—then another, a
little sway across the rug, leaving
behind a dotted trail leading to
nowhere. A curve here, a loop
there, smearing a heart onto the
plush, a lover's note scrawled by
trembling hands. Kneeling
down on your last breath, on your
back, smooth floor, arms spread
wide—angel-wing prints
stamped in red, teeth blotted bright,
cheeks still pink. A tiny bell of a
laugh, light and silvery,
tangling with a cat's yowl, the scrape
of chalk on pavement, sugared air
clinging—only a
thunderstorm could wash it away.

Begging, stay.

Pale, throbbing skin sinks into the
cream rug, drinking in the bloom of
red. A shame, really, that
pristine surface. Eyes flutter,
closing—has your throat shut already?
Small 'o's form at your lips,
tracing the glass lodged deep,
glinting like a jewel sprouting from
your skin. Pluck it free, like a
firefly from a jar, like a loose note
tugged from the pages of a book.

Free it, breathe it—deepening, thickening, pooling around you.

Annabella, my dear, flailing,
twisting—the earth beneath
you will soon crack and pull
you under.
Don't dwell. After all, isn't
it more fun this way?

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